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**Eric Schertler**  
**National Fish and Wildlife Foundation**  
**Project Officer**  
[Eric.Schertler@nfwf.org](mailto:Eric.Schertler@nfwf.org)

Memo - Scope of Work Revision Request Project #84304

March 26, 2026

Dear Mr. Schertler,

We are sending this memo to describe proposed changes to National Coastal Resilience Fund project #84304, "Landscape Planning and Mapping Salmon Habitat for Protection in the Kenai Peninsula Borough (AK)." As ours is a research-based mapping and outreach effort, our work evolves as we carry out the project. Our proposed changes are intended to fulfill the identical research themes as described in the approved work plan, focusing on a modified geographic area and including a new agency/tribal collaboration opportunity.

In this revision request we include three sections:

- 1) A memo to project collaborators Romey Riverscape Sciences and Terrainworks describing the new proposed geographic scope
- 2) Other proposed project revisions, primarily travel

All project metrics target values are unchanged as part of the proposed revision of scope of work.

We will await NFWF's decision as to whether a full, formal scope of work revision is needed, or if all or part of the requested revisions are approved.

Thank you for your support and cooperation. Sincerely,

Benjamin Meyer  
Research Coordinator, Kenai Watershed Forum  
[ben@kenaiwatershed.org](mailto:ben@kenaiwatershed.org)  
(907) 232 - 0280



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## 1) Memo to Project Collaborators on Revised Geographic Scope

cc: Bernard Romey ([bnar@rom3y.com](mailto:bnar@rom3y.com)) (Romey Riverscape Sciences)  
Kevin Andras ([kevin@kevinandras.com](mailto:kevin@kevinandras.com)) (Terrainworks)

March 20, 2026

### Memo: Proposed Geographic Focus Areas for NFWF project 84304, "Landscape Planning and Mapping Salmon Habitat for Protection in the Kenai Peninsula Borough (AK)."

In 2025, KWF gained extensive experience in the time-consuming labor of performing quality-control work on watershed network map outputs. Due to the volume of this workflow, we propose a revised geographic scope for our mapping effort in this project, focusing on areas of high conservation priority and existing auxiliary datasets. For 2026, we will largely focus fieldwork efforts within the Kenai River Watershed and one headwaters area of Granite Creek near Turnagain Pass. Within these boundaries, we will direct initial fieldwork and modeling efforts on four sub-watersheds: Lower Kenai River (HUC10), Russian River (two HUC12s), Ptarmigan Creek (HUC12), and Granite Creek (HUC12).

| Table 1. Focus areas for Kenai River fish habitat modeling efforts and rationale |                   |          |              |                                  |                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------|--------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Fieldwork Priority                                                               | Drainage Name     | HUC Size | HUC Unit     | HUC Name                         | Notes                            |
| 1                                                                                | Lower Kenai River | 10       | 1902030218   | Lower Kenai River                | Conservation priorities; access  |
| 1                                                                                | Russian River     | 12       | 190203021405 | Outlet Russian River             | Rationale: accessibility         |
|                                                                                  |                   | 12       | 190203021404 | Headwaters Russian River         | Rationale: accessibility         |
| 1                                                                                | Ptarmigan Creek   | 12       | 190203021203 | Ptarmigan Lake - Ptarmigan Creek | Rationale: accessibility         |
| 2                                                                                | Granite Creek     | 12       | 190203020406 | Granite Creek                    | Some fieldwork done 2025; access |
| 3                                                                                | Moose River       | 10       | 1902030216   | Moose River                      | Accessibility; local interest    |

Figure 1 shows the full project boundary, which is the political boundary of the Kenai Peninsula Borough.

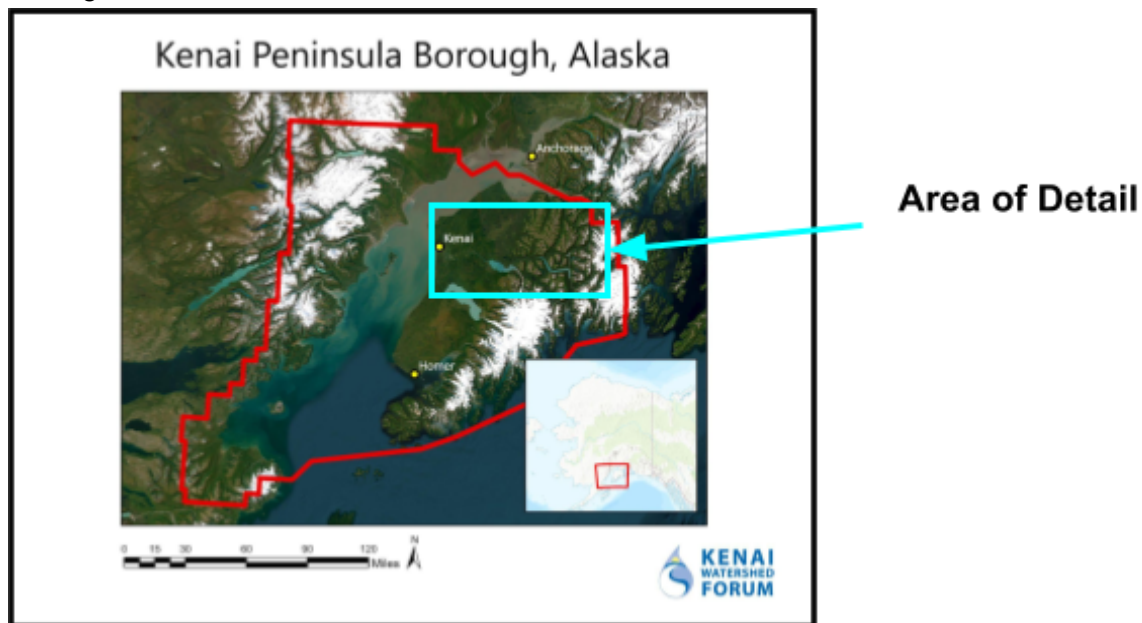


Figure 2 shows the described geographic areas for the scope of work revision request



*Figure 1. Kenai River watershed boundaries (turquoise), with focus sub-watersheds in orange (Lower Kenai River, Russian River, Ptarmigan Creek, Moose River, and Granite Creek)*



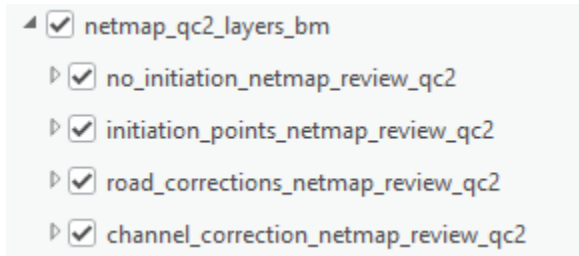
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Several attachments are included:

- Zip files containing shapefiles of watershed boundaries described above
  - kenai\_river\_watershed\_huc\_boundary.zip
  - kenai\_focus\_hucs.zip
- Zip files of manual QC2 corrections performed by KWF in March 2026



- → **QC2 corrections have been created only within the focus areas described in this memo. We request updated NetMap flow lines within these boundaries**
- QC1 corrections from Fall 2025 are also included in this zip file

Notes on future project strategy:

We will leverage the success of results from focus in these areas to seek funding for continuing work in the remainder of the Kenai River watershed, then expanding to the remainder of the Kenai Peninsula, then the Kenai Peninsula Borough.

- Benjamin Meyer  
[ben@kenaiwatershed.org](mailto:ben@kenaiwatershed.org)  
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## 2) Other Proposed Revisions

### A) Travel to Hoonah, Alaska

**Rationale:** Our project was inspired by the example of the Hoonah Native Forest Partnership (HNFP), a cooperative entity in southeast Alaska that uses tribal, agency, and corporate funds to support local forest and watershed stewardship with local employees. We have been invited to visit and learn from HNFP in June 2026. Our visit would serve as a critical link for regional knowledge-sharing, offering an up-close view of a successful regional partnership template. Our four day visit would consist of meeting with HNFP staff, supporting fieldwork efforts, and learning local protocol applicable to our project on the Kenai Peninsula.

Given the unique regional nature of our research, we find this opportunity similarly valuable to our original plans to attend a professional scientific conference.

**Cost Narrative:** Two KWF staff travel round trip from Kenai, AK to Hoonah, AK in June 2026. Housing and local transportation costs are negligible thanks to partnership with HNFP.

#### **Estimated Travel Costs Per Person:**

- Round-trip flights Kenai to Hoonah
  - Kenai - Anchorage: \$300
  - Anchorage - Juneau: \$446
  - Juneau - Hoonah: \$300
    - Total flights: \$1046
- Per-diem per person
  - 5 nights in Hoonah at federal DoD rate (meals & incidentals) @\$114/night = \$570
- Lodging
  - USFS bunk house at \$20/night per person, 5 nights = \$100
- Total per person: \$1716
- Total (two people): \$3432

### B) Backpack Electrofisher Training in Fairbanks, Alaska

**Rationale:** The Alaska Dept of Fish and Game requires all users of backpack electrofishers to complete a 2.5 day in-person training course. Kenai Watershed Forum hired one new full time scientist in Spring 2026 who will need to take this training. Use of a backpack electrofisher is a critical function of staff involved in this project, and this training will serve as critical skills development for an early-career scientist.

#### **Estimated Costs (One Person):**

- Round-trip flight Kenai to Fairbanks
  - Kenai - Anchorage: \$300



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- Anchorage - Fairbanks: \$275
    - Total flights: \$575
  - Per-diem per person
    - 4 nights in Fairbanks at federal DoD rate (meals & incidentals) @\$106/night = \$424
  - Lodging
    - 4 nights in Fairbanks, Maximum Allowed Lodging per-diem @\$279/night = \$1116
  - Course Registration
    - \$250 (through American Fisheries Society)
  - Total: \$2365

#### C) Local Vehicle Mileage

Local transportation is a central element of this project, as the work involves traveling to sites throughout the Kenai Peninsula to perform fieldwork. With rapidly rising fuel costs in 2026, we wish to re-direct funds not described above from the category of “Travel/Domestic Airfare/Fieldwork-flights” to “Travel/Mileage-per mile/Fieldwork-vehicle travel” as described below.

#### D) Reconciliation between proposed budget revision and old budget

The current approved budget lists \$8000 for local flights in small planes to remote fieldwork sites. After one year experience and greater familiarity of the nature of this research, such flights may not be critical to successful research outcomes. Thus, we wish to re-direct these funds towards the purposes described in sections A, B, and C above.

| Activity                                                   | Cost   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Travel to Hoonah to visit Hoonah Native Forest Partnership | \$3432 |
| Travel to Fairbanks for Electrofishing course              | \$2365 |
| Local vehicle mileage                                      | \$2203 |
| Total                                                      | \$8000 |